

WE ARE COMMUNITY TRANSFORMATION

In Matthew 13 Jesus taught the disciples and the multitudes utilizing parables. A parable is a simple, life-like story, that is used to teach a moral or spiritual lesson. In this chapter Jesus taught on:

- The parable of the sower
- The parable of the wheat and tares
- The parable of the mustard seed
- The parable of the leaven

The shortest, yet most complex parable He taught on, was the parable of the leaven.

Matthew 1:33 (NKJV) ***“Another parable He spoke to them: “The kingdom of heaven is like leaven, which a woman took and hid in three measures of meal till it was all leavened.”***

The New Living Translation states it like this, ***“The Kingdom of Heaven is like the yeast a woman used in making bread. Even though***

she put only a little yeast in three measures of flour, it permeated every part of the dough."

Today we are focusing on the parable of the yeast. In thinking through our focus of each of us becoming Community Transformation, I would say, that this church has become the yeast of Heaven to Southeast Houston and the world.

I want to take you on a journey in the next few minutes that will cover the last 100 years.

Community Transformation Church is the result of two churches coming together in a merger, in the early 1970's. Oaklawn and Magnolia Park (Place pics of these two churches on the screen – Talk about these two churches) (Have people to stand who were a part of either of those churches)

In 1976 Rev. O.C. and Jackie Bates became the Pastors of Oaklawn, and soon after Rev. E.M. Yates, who had been the pastor of Magnolia

Park for 52 years, retired from the pastorate. These two churches merged, and formed Christian Temple. In 1983 the facility we worship in today was completed and opened on Easter of that year. (Place the original picture of CT church building on the screen) (Have everyone to stand who were a part of the church at that time)

In the spring of 2001 Brother and Sister Bates resigned as the Pastors after serving 25 years. In November of 2001, Susan and I were elected as the pastors of this great church.

Sometime after being elected to this church, I was approached by some leaders, with the idea of selling this property and relocating to a different part of the city. I went on a 21 day fast and the Lord spoke to me and said, “*Do not move this church, reach this community.*” So for the last 21 years, that is what we have attempted to do. As a result, we have gone from a predominantly white, older, commuter church,

to a very multi-ethnic, multi-generational, multi-site church. Corporately, this church has become the yeast in this area, and to some degree around the nation and the world.

YEAST LOOKS WEAK

Yeast actually looks like sand. If one were to judge yeast based on its appearance, one would not give it a second thought, with regard to its ability to change anything.

What can one church do in the face of a community and world that is going downhill at an alarming rate? I am about to share the answer with you.

Soon after we became the pastors of this church, we led the church to start doing outreach into the community, praying over the community, knocking on doors, etc... (I have probably personally knocked on more doors in this area than anyone)

As a result, this church has gone from being known as “*The church with a steeple – To the church known for its outreaches.*” In the event of a natural disaster, this community will automatically come to this property before they go anywhere else. That is what the yeast of the Gospel does. SHOUT – “*I AM COMMUNITY TRANSFORMATION!*”

YEAST IS NEVER INTIMIDATED BY THE SIZE OF THE DOUGH

This church has taken on some of the biggest issues without being afraid of the consequences.

- We worked and prayed and the pay-by-the-hour motels came down! SHOUT – “*I AM COMMUNITY TRANSFORMATION!*”
- We Worked and prayed and the sexually explicit businesses left! SHOUT – “*I AM COMMUNITY TRANSFORMATION!*”
- We worked and prayed and the psychics went out of business! SHOUT – “*I AM COMMUNITY TRANSFORMATION!*”
- We worked and prayed and Walmart built a

supercenter where the motels were! SHOUT – *“I AM COMMUNITY TRANSFORMATION!”*

- We worked and prayed and thousands of homes have been built! SHOUT – *“I AM COMMUNITY TRANSFORMATION!”*
- We worked and prayed and 8 new public schools have been built within a three-mile radius of this church! SHOUT – *“I AM COMMUNITY TRANSFORMATION!”*
- We worked and prayed and three charter schools have been built within a three-mile radius of this church! SHOUT – *“I AM COMMUNITY TRANSFORMATION!”*
- We worked and prayed and we now have two charter schools that meet at two of our locations! Over 1,500 students per day are being educated in those Two schools alone! This church had such a reputation of being the yeast of the gospel in this area, that when we placed a sign out front, *“Tuition free charter school, enrolling now,”* parents and children lined up down the sidewalks! The

charter school has had a waiting list since the day it opened! (For almost 10 years now)
SHOUT – *“I AM COMMUNITY TRANSFORMATION!”*

- We have worked and prayed and Community Transformation Church has seven campuses in three states! SHOUT – *“I AM COMMUNITY TRANSFORMATION!”*

Trust me when I say, the yeast of Community Transformation Church is not afraid of the dough of the world, but I can tell you the dough respects the yeast. (Story of local business owner who kept trying to open a beer joint)

YEAST WORKS QUIETLY

Those of you who bake, have you ever heard the yeast doing its work? While you can't hear what the yeast is doing, you can certainly see the results over time.

This church hasn't picketed anyone, we haven't marched on anyone, we haven't rioted against

anything – BUT the results are clearly visible!
(When I talk about each of these ministries,
place their logos and information on the screen)

- Project Hope and Saving Grace... 8 centers in five states – 270 beds – Free recovery ministry - \$12 million dollars a year! SHOUT – “*I AM COMMUNITY TRANSFORMATION!*”
- Home of Hope – Rescuing 8-17-year-old girls, who have been trafficked – This is not an awareness program, it is actually dealing with the precious girls, and their families that have been affected! The cost to do this ministry is approximately \$70,000 per month! Faith based ministry! SHOUT – “*I AM COMMUNITY TRANSFORMATION!*”
- Global Ministries Network – Working with Pastors, Churches, Evangelists, and missionaries around the world! SHOUT – “*I AM COMMUNITY TRANSFORMATION!*”
- Missionary support of missionaries worldwide! This church has a global footprint! SHOUT – “*I AM COMMUNITY*

TRANSFORMATION!”

- At His Feet Ministries – Caring for the food and clothing needs of this area! (Richard and Joanna Vega) SHOUT – “*I AM COMMUNITY TRANSFORMATION!”*”
- Burnt Offerings – Cooking and distributing food to the victims and first responders, in times of crisis and natural disasters! (Steve and Libby Lang) SHOUT – “*I AM COMMUNITY TRANSFORMATION!”*”
- Empowerment Conference – Scholarshipping and ministering to hundreds of ministers from around the world – The cost to do this is now over \$200,000 per year. SHOUT – “*I AM COMMUNITY TRANSFORMATION!”*”

You have become the yeast in all of this – You have been the ones who have volunteered and supplied the resources to do these things!

SHOUT – “*I AM COMMUNITY TRANSFORMATION!”*”

YEAST NEVER BECOMES DOUGH

We are “*In the world, but we are not of the world.*” Make no mistake about it, we are to be the yeast, not the dough! We are to never get lost in the culture of the world, we are Kingdom citizens and we march to the beat of a different drummer! We are marching to the orders of no King but Jesus!

The yeast influences the dough, the dough has no effect on the yeast! We are salt and light!

God wants us to infect the entire culture:

- Business
- Government
- Media
- Arts & Entertainment
- Education
- Family
- Religion

Much has been done through this church, but we

have only just begun! I believe this church is about to step into a new season where we take this mandate from a corporate level, to a personal level! When this transition is made in our minds and spirits, the results will become exponential! The transition that we must make is that we go from WE ARE COMMUNITY TRANSFORMATION! – To - I AM COMMUNITY TRANSFORMATION!

SHOUT “*I AM COMMUNITY TRANSFORMATION!*”

It's time for each of us to open the packet of yeast within us, and RISE up to the occasion of BECOMING, NOT DOING, community transformation!